

4.5 Diagnostic Bacteriology II

▼ What type of bodily structure are tonsils?

- They are **secondary lymphatic organs** found at the back of the mouth on either side of the epiglottis

▼ What is tonsillitis?

- Inflammation of the tonsils.

▼ What causes tonsillitis?

- It is usually caused by a **viral infection** - some cases are caused by **bacterial infections**.

▼ What is streptococcus pyogenes?

- An alternative name for the pathogenic Streptococcus A bacteria which cause infections such as strep throat, sepsis, tonsillitis and scarlet fever

▼ How can clostridium difficile infections arise?

- C. difficile bacteria typically live in the gastrointestinal tract
- During the use of (specifically broad-spectrum) antibiotics, these C. difficile bacteria can become resistant and have advantages over others (strep A doesn't become resistant)
- This causes them to replicate faster and increase in number, and infection is spread across the body.